

DENISE R. SMITH

Brand & Lifecycle Marketing Leader • B2B Demand Generation • CRM & Customer Growth Strategy • AI-Driven Marketing

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Director-level Brand and Lifecycle Marketing leader with 15+ years of progressive experience architecting how products and organizations are positioned in market — from brand narrative through full-funnel demand generation, lifecycle growth, and strategic partnership development. Proven track record building brand strategies and negotiating high-impact vendor partnerships that connect product capabilities to real customer pain points, driving awareness, trust, conversion, and loyalty across the B2B buyer journey for both Small and Medium-sized Business (SMB) and enterprise audiences.

Skilled at translating complex data environments into compelling content strategies and audience-specific messaging that solves real problems — not just sounds good on paper. Hands-on experience leading thought leadership programs, content creation, community engagement, and reputation management alongside CRM and lifecycle execution, including brokering and launching first-of-platform SaaS partnerships that turned customer voice into measurable trust and conversion. Brings a data-oriented, test-and-learn discipline that connects brand investment to measurable pipeline outcomes.

Most recently applied this expertise within the construction technology industry — building logic, prompts, MCPs (Model Context Protocol integrations), and ROI-focused dashboards that brought AI-driven automation into marketing and construction intelligence workflows. Developed AI-powered prototypes for pre-construction estimating, lead research automation, content productivity, and project value forecasting, establishing proof-of-concept for AI integration across marketing and product workflows.

Adept at managing multi-million-dollar marketing budgets, negotiating and closing strategic vendor contracts, building high-performing teams, and leading cross-functional execution across Marketing, Technology, Product, Analytics, Legal, and Sales teams. Strong collaborator and people manager who brings clarity, creative direction, and strategic accountability to every team dynamic.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Brand Positioning & Strategy • Thought Leadership & Content Marketing • B2B Demand Generation • ICP Research & Audience Targeting • Buyer Journey Optimization • Community & Reputation Management • Full-Funnel Lifecycle Strategy • CRM & Customer Segmentation • AI-Driven Marketing Prototyping • Omnichannel Campaign Execution • Small and Medium-sized Business (SMB) & Enterprise Marketing • MarTech Stack Management • Performance Analytics & Reporting • A/B Testing & Experimentation • Marketing Budget Management • Agency & Vendor Management • Strategic Partnerships & Contract Negotiation • Cross-Functional Leadership • People Management • Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) Optimization • Email Marketing & Automation • Data-Driven Decision Making • CAN-SPAM / Deliverability Compliance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Content Specialist & Marketing Intelligence Contributor — Extended Scope

January 2025 – July 2026

[ConstructConnect](#) | Atlanta, GA (Remote)

In addition to core role responsibilities in construction intelligence, independently extended into AI-driven marketing innovation — prototyping tools and building infrastructure that connected construction data to real-world marketing and business outcomes.

- Independently built AI-powered prototypes to surface ROI across pre-construction workflows — including automated estimating support, lead research, content productivity tools, and project value forecasting — then partnered with internal product, training, and marketing teams to validate and advance proof-of-concept for AI integration into core construction intelligence products.
- Developed logic, prompts, and MCPs (Model Context Protocol integrations) from the ground up to automate lead research and content workflows; subsequently collaborated with team management to refine and improve input/output project quality information for clients.
- Built dashboards to visualize pipeline intelligence, audience behavior, and performance metrics — then partnered with marketing, training, and product teams to connect insights to actionable brand, marketing, and operational strategy recommendations.
- Originated and contributed brand-adjacent content frameworks informed by ICP (Integrated Construction Platform) research and customer pain points in the construction technology space; collaborated with marketing, training, and product teams to connect product capabilities to real-world customer outcomes across all segments.
- Managed full construction project lifecycle data (pre-design through post-bid), developing systems-level understanding of audience behavior and stakeholder communication analogous to CRM pipeline for client journey management.
- Maintained rigorous data governance and quality assurance standards across a high-volume, deadline-driven publishing environment — directly transferable to KPI reporting, marketing analytics, and content integrity.

Marketing & Operations Director

December 2023 – January 2025

K & E Cleaning | Cincinnati, OH (Remote)

Accepted this role as a purposeful bridge position during a personal caregiving period. Held dual responsibility for both the full marketing and growth function and day-to-day business operations — including financial management, vendor and property relationships, and operational oversight — while the owner retained hiring authority. Delivered measurable results across revenue growth, client retention, and operational efficiency within a small-business environment.

- Increased gross profit by 25% within 9 months through a combination of strategic marketing initiatives, client retention programs, and operational process improvements.
- Developed and executed end-to-end marketing strategies — including digital content, promotional campaigns, and competitive positioning — to drive new client acquisition and market expansion.
- Determined competitive service rates and pricing structures for submitted RFPs, balancing market positioning, profitability targets, and client acquisition goals to maximize contract win rates.
- Authored persuasive RFPs and tailored proposals resulting in new contract wins; managed the full bid-to-award lifecycle for commercial acquisition opportunities.
- Owned accounts receivable and financial reconciliation functions — managing invoicing, tracking outstanding balances, and improving cash flow through disciplined collections processes.
- Managed vendor and property management relationships, serving as primary point of contact for service agreements, negotiations, and ongoing partnership accountability.
- Oversaw day-to-day business operations, ensuring continuity, quality standards, and process consistency across all operational functions outside of direct hiring.

Assistant Vice President – Sr. Lifecycle Marketing Lead

August 2018 – November 2023

Synchrony | Charlotte, NC (Remote)

GENERAL PURPOSE CREDIT CARD LAUNCH | PORTFOLIO GROWTH | LIFECYCLE MARKETING

Founding member of Synchrony's newly created General Purpose Credit Card business unit. Helped launch the Synchrony Mastercard and scale the portfolio from 1 to 3 products, leading end-to-end lifecycle marketing across acquisition, onboarding, engagement, retention, and loyalty. Owned a \$3MM annual marketing budget and drove data-driven initiatives that grew customer lifetime value, reduced attrition, and compounded cardholder engagement and spend over time. As Lifecycle Marketing Lead, successfully brokered and closed a strategic contract with Yotpo, securing the platform's first successful native integration of Ratings & Reviews for the Synchrony general purpose Mastercard products (2% and 1%) — a first-of-its-kind capability that directly strengthened customer trust, loyalty, and conversion across the portfolio.

- Negotiated and closed a strategic software contract with Yotpo, spearheading the successful integration of user-generated content (UGC) to enhance product credibility and surface direct cardholder sentiment on the Synchrony Mastercard portfolio.
- Led the end-to-end integration of Ratings & Reviews, building out social proof templates and review syndication features directly into the core product (Synchrony Mastercard 2% and 1%), establishing a new content pipeline shown to build trust and drive conversion.
- Built a foundational partnership with Yotpo, launching the platform's first Ratings & Reviews tool to bridge the gap between product feedback and consumer purchasing decisions for the portfolio.
- Delivered the first successful implementation of Yotpo for the platform, establishing critical API workflows and custom review forms and paving the way for future marketing technology partnerships.
- Led customer migration strategy following the Toys "R" Us portfolio liquidation; converted cardholders spent approximately 40% more than legacy Toys "R" Us cardholders — demonstrating successful portfolio migration, lifecycle re-engagement, and long-term customer retention.
- Managed a \$3MM lifecycle marketing budget, consistently delivering against revenue growth, engagement, and retention targets while maintaining an annual 3% attrition rate.
- Increased email open rates by 10% and click-through rates by 4% through rigorous A/B testing, audience segmentation, and personalization strategies.
- Championed cardholder segmentation and marketing personalization across consumer-facing campaigns, driving top-of-wallet loyalty and increased card usage frequency.
- Leveraged behavioral signals and customer data to build segmented lifecycle programs that drove measurable improvements in conversion, early retention, and top-of-wallet loyalty across a growing multi-product portfolio.
- Revamped total lifecycle marketing communication design and workflow architecture, improving speed-to-market and campaign consistency across onboarding, engagement, and win-back journeys.
- Partnered with cross-functional teams — Technology, Analytics, Legal, and Product — to integrate customer data for improved segmentation, journey personalization, and compliance.
- Collaborated with external creative agencies and SaaS partners — including Movable Ink — on conceptual design, development, and approval of lifecycle marketing creative; managed deliverables, timelines, and performance accountability.

Email Manager, Digital Marketing

October 2015 – August 2018

Synchrony | Atlanta, GA (Remote)

- Reduced email speed-to-market from 4 weeks to 2 weeks and cycle time from a 28-day SLA to 5 days or less, enabling clients to mirror in-store offers with richer, more timely email campaigns.

- Executed 343 email campaigns with zero error rate — a department high — demonstrating operational excellence in a demanding, high-volume marketing environment.
- Managed list segmentation, email builds, and deployment of client campaigns; served as SME on platform capabilities, email design best practices, and deliverability standards.
- Drove mobile optimization adoption through responsive design implementation across the full email program.

District Sales Manager, Property & Casualty

July 2014 – October 2015

Acceptance Insurance | Atlanta, GA

- Directed day-to-day sales performance across a 4-store Metro Atlanta cluster (East Point #0083, Forest Park #0034, Douglasville #0101, Griffin #0014), spending 70% of the week in-market delivering live side-by-side coaching and post-visit action plans that moved the quote-to-bind ratio from 20% to 25%.
- Shifted store management focus from lagging results to leading indicators — directing store managers to build grassroots B2B referral pipelines with local used-car dealerships, body shops, tow companies, and apartment complexes, and instituting a mandatory daily “Power Hour” outbound-calling block to convert lost quotes, expiring policies, and multi-car upsell opportunities.
- Reduced policy attrition through a proactive 3-day/7-day grace-call system that saved at-risk policies before lapse, while building a continuously recruited “talent bench” to eliminate staffing gaps and coaching store managers to independently run daily huddles, review store P&Ls, and resolve team conflicts.

Licensed Agent, Property & Casualty

December 2013 – July 2014

Acceptance Insurance | Atlanta, GA

- Expanded business book by 209 accounts in five months; increased retail revenue sales by 12.8% and renewal rate by 3.5% through aggressive acquisition marketing and customer retention strategies.
- Developed and applied marketing techniques, best practices, and strategies to drive sales and build referral partnerships with standard agencies, car dealerships, and other sources.

Email Manager, Digital Marketing

June 2012 – December 2013

RentPath | Atlanta, GA (Hybrid)

- Project-managed full email platform vendor migration: coordinated stakeholder communication, maintained timelines, drove process improvements, and resolved platform issues across all transition phases.
- Championed email best practices — A/B testing, segmentation, personalization, and template optimization — and delivered monthly performance reporting and recommendations to key stakeholders.

Senior Email Manager, Digital Marketing

January 2012 – June 2012

Epsilon | Atlanta, GA

- Agency-side client partner managing CRM digital campaigns for The Home Depot account across Pro, Garden, and Ad-Hoc segments within B2B and B2C channels.
- Managed campaign prioritization, data requirements, QA testing, and successful email launches; performed A/B testing and communicated findings and recommendations to stakeholders.

Email Manager, Digital Marketing

June 2009 – December 2011

Truist Bank | Atlanta, GA (Hybrid)

- Managed email calendar, campaign prioritization, segmentation, QA, and deliverability; ensured successful campaign launch across all outbound programs.
- Led email platform vendor migration: coordinated stakeholder communication, maintained timelines, drove process improvements throughout all migration phases.
- Delivered monthly performance reporting and audience insights to key stakeholders; made data-driven recommendations to continuously improve campaign effectiveness.

SAAS & MARKETING TECHNOLOGY PLATFORMS

Marketing & CRM Platforms: Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC), Aprimo, Salesforce CRM, Mediaocean, Movable Ink, Yotpo, Hootsuite, SurveyMonkey, Adobe Workfront, SharePoint

Email Service Providers (ESPs): Adobe Campaign, Acoustic Campaign, Epsilon Harmony, Oracle Responsys, NCR Atleos (Banking)

Email Quality & Deliverability: Litmus, ReturnPath, Email on Acid, BriteVerify (Validity), MxToolbox

Analytics & Reporting: Tableau, Power BI, Google Suite, Microsoft Office

Creative & Design Tools: Adobe Creative Cloud, Canva, SundaySky

AI & Research Tools: Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Glean, Perplexity

Other: HTML (Basic)

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

Bachelor of Business Administration – Marketing | University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, OH

Web Design – Kennesaw Internet Professional (KIP) | Kennesaw State University Continuing Education, Kennesaw, GA